

About This Rework

I'll keep it short; ever since D&D 5e: 2024 edition dropped, a lot of people have mentioned that Ranger just felt kind of bad. It didn't see many substantial changes from Tasha's, and mechanically? It starts to fall behind other classes once you get into the middle levels, and it never really recovers. Many players have expressed that playing a Ranger beyond level 9 felt pointless, with most choosing to drop it around 5 or 6 and begin multiclassing (usually to Druid or Rogue).

As someone whose first character was a Ranger, they have a special place in my heart; I wanted to take a stab at fixing some of the issues with the class—and hopefully bringing back some of its lost identity in the process. Rangers should *feel* like rangers—like deadly hunters and precise trackers, like skilled warriors who have traveled the lands and attuned to nature, with an adaptable, versatile skillset to take down whatever their target is. This rework should hopefully help Rangers feel like that again. At the same time, this is a rework *specifically* of the 2024 Ranger; as such, I tried not to stray too far from their new core design (meaning Hunter's Mark is here to stay). This way, 2024 subclasses should work perfectly with the rework without needing to be adjusted individually. If a particular subclass ends up being too strong when combined with the rework, feel free to nerf either the subclass or a problematic element of the class! I've also tried to incorporate more Short Rest-based mechanics, allowing Rangers the ability to catch their breath during an adventuring day, so to speak; they can adapt, recharge, and be ready to go quickly, making them better for longer adventuring days than many other classes.

TO UNDERSTAND THIS REWORK, I HAVE KEPT THE CHANGES SIMPLE TO FOLLOW. The core class has been copied over. Any changes or additions to the class have been noted: an asterisk () next to a feature name indicates that the feature has been changed, while two asterisks indicate a feature is entirely new; changed or added text is **SLIGHTLY OUTLINED IN GREEN**. Where possible, I have tried to provide feature/design explanations as well.*

Ranger Class Details

Core Ranger Traits

Primary Ability	Dexterity and Wisdom
Hit Point Die	D10 per Ranger level
Saving Throw Proficiencies	Strength and Dexterity
Skill Proficiencies	Choose 3: Animal Handling , Athletics , Insight , Investigation , Nature , Perception , Stealth , or Survival
Weapon Proficiencies	Simple and Martial weapons
Armor Training	Light and Medium armor and Shields
Starting Equipment	Choose A or B: (A) Studded Leather Armor , Scimitar , Shortsword , Longbow , 20 Arrows , Quiver , Druidic Focus (sprig of mistletoe) , Explorer's Pack , and 7 GP; or (B) 150 GP

Far from bustling cities, amid the trees of trackless forests and across wide plains, Rangers keep their unending watch in the wilderness. Rangers learn to track their quarry as a predator does, moving stealthily through the wilds and hiding themselves in brush and rubble.

Thanks to their connection with nature, Rangers can also cast spells that harness primal powers of the wilderness. A Ranger's talents and magic are honed with deadly focus to protect the world from the ravages of monsters and tyrants.

Becoming a Ranger...

As a Level 1 Character

- Gain all the traits in the Core Ranger Traits table.
- Gain the Ranger's level 1 features, which are listed in the Ranger Features table.

As a Multiclass Character

- Gain the following traits from the Core Ranger Traits table: Hit Point Die, proficiency with Martial weapons, proficiency in one skill of your choice from the Ranger's skill list, and training with Light and Medium armor and Shields.
- Gain the Ranger's level 1 features, which are listed in the Ranger Features table. See the multiclassing rules to determine your available spell slots.

Ranger Features Table

				—Spell Slots per Spell Level—					
Level	Proficiency Bonus	Class Features	Favored Enemy	Prepared Spells	1	2	3	4	5
1	+2	*Spellcasting, *Favored Enemy, Weapon Mastery	2	2	2	—	—	—	—
2	+2	*Deft Explorer, *Fighting Style, **Tracker’s Quarry	2	3	2	—	—	—	—
3	+2	Ranger Subclass	2	4	3	—	—	—	—
4	+2	Ability Score Improvement	2	5	3	—	—	—	—
5	+3	Extra Attack	3	6	4	2	—	—	—
6	+3	*Roving, **Nature’s Fury	3	6	4	2	—	—	—

7	+3	Subclass feature	3	7	4	3	—	—	—
8	+3	Ability Score Improvement	3	7	4	3	—	—	—
9	+4	Expertise, *Tireless	4	9	4	3	2	—	—
10	+4	**Hunter's Precision	4	9	4	3	2	—	—
11	+4	Subclass feature	4	10	4	3	3	—	—
12	+4	Ability Score Improvement	4	10	4	3	3	—	—
13	+5	**Relentless Striker	5	11	4	3	3	1	—
14	+5	Nature's Veil	5	11	4	3	3	1	—
15	+5	Subclass feature	5	12	4	3	3	2	—

16	+5	Ability Score Improvement	5	12	4	3	3	2	—
17	+6	**Executioner's Mark	6	14	4	3	3	3	1
18	+6	*Feral Senses	6	14	4	3	3	3	1
19	+6	Epic Boon	6	15	4	3	3	3	2
20	+6	*Foe Slayer	6	15	4	3	3	3	2

Ranger Class Features

As a Ranger, you gain the following class features when you reach the specified Ranger levels. These features are listed in the Ranger Features table.

*Level 1: Spellcasting

You have learned to channel the magical essence of nature to cast spells.

Spell Slots. The Ranger Features table shows how many spell slots you have to cast your level 1+ spells. You regain all expended slots when you finish a Long Rest.

Prepared Spells of Level 1+. You prepare the list of level 1+ spells that are available for you to cast with this feature. To start, choose two level 1 Ranger spells.

The number of spells on your list increases as you gain Ranger levels, as shown in the Prepared Spells column of the Ranger Features table. Whenever that number increases, choose additional Ranger spells until the number of spells on your list matches the number in the Ranger Features table. The chosen spells must be of a level for which you have spell slots. For example, if you're a level 5 Ranger, your list of prepared spells can include six Ranger spells of level 1 or 2 in any combination.

If another Ranger feature gives you spells that you always have prepared, those spells don't count against the number of spells you can prepare with this feature, but those spells otherwise count as Ranger spells for you.

Changing Your Prepared Spells. Whenever you finish a Long Rest, you can **change your list of prepared spells, replacing any of the spells there with other Ranger spells for which you have spell slots. Additionally, whenever you finish a Short Rest, you can swap one Ranger spell that you have prepared for a different one from the Ranger list.**

Spellcasting Ability. Wisdom is your spellcasting ability for your Ranger spells.

Spellcasting Focus. You can use a Druidic Focus as a Spellcasting Focus for your Ranger spells.

Note: This change is intended to help improve the versatility and adaptability of Rangers. It always seemed odd to me that Rangers couldn't effectively adapt their spells to help with their expected adventuring day. The inclusion of a Short Rest replacement also helps with adapting during the day; find out your quest to slay a dragon is actually slaying a hydra, and you need to make a small adjustment? Much easier to do that with this.

*Level 1: Favored Enemy

You always have the **Hunter's Mark** spell prepared. You can cast it twice without expending a spell slot, and you regain all expended uses of this ability when you finish a Long Rest.

You also regain one expended use when you finish a Short Rest.

The number of times you can cast the spell without a spell slot increases when you reach certain Ranger levels.

Note: This addition helps mainly with subclass features that use your Favored Enemy for their own mechanics, like Hollow Warden. With the changes in this class, Hunter's Mark is much more desirable, so being able to use your subclass and still have extra Favored Enemy uses for Hunter's Mark is a nice quality of life change without drastically altering the number of uses available at any given moment. It also helps incentivize Rangers to take Short Rests, something many classes were incentivized to do in 2024.

Level 1: Weapon Mastery

Your training with weapons allows you to use the mastery properties of two kinds of weapons of your choice with which you have proficiency, such as Longbows and Shortswords.

Whenever you finish a Long Rest, you can change the kinds of weapons you chose. For example, you could switch to using the mastery properties of Scimitars and Longswords.

*Level 2: Deft Explorer

Thanks to your travels, you gain the following benefits.

Expertise. Choose one of your skill proficiencies with which you lack Expertise. You gain [Expertise](#) in that skill.

Languages. You know two languages of your choice.

Terrain Expert. Whenever you finish a Long Rest, you can select a terrain choice from the following options: aquatic, arctic, coast, desert, forest, grassland, mountain, subterranean, or swamp. While in an environment that matches your chosen terrain, you gain the following benefits:

Swift Pace. You can ignore the effects of natural Difficult Terrain. Traveling at a fast pace does not impose disadvantage on your Wisdom (Perception and Survival) and Dexterity (Stealth) checks.

Experienced Traveler. You can gather twice as much food whenever you forage in your chosen environment. Additionally, when you and your allies push yourselves to continue traveling beyond the recommended duration, you gain advantage on the saving throw against Exhaustion.

Camouflage Expert. You have advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks when not traveling at a fast pace.

Threat Detector. You can use your Wisdom modifier in place of your Intelligence for ability checks relating to creatures either native to or living in your chosen terrain. You gain this benefit, even while you are outside your chosen terrain.

Note: This addition helps bring in some additional out-of-combat utility to the class while also returning some of the old flavor from the 2014 Ranger. This feature is very similar to the Natural Explorer feature of that class, although it has been improved in some ways to make it more useful at most tables.

*Level 2: Fighting Style

You gain a Fighting Style feat of your choice. Instead of choosing one of those feats, you can choose the option below. **If you later gain a Fighting Style feat, you may add the option below to the choices available for that feat.**

Druidic Warrior

You learn two Druid cantrips of your choice. The chosen cantrips count as Ranger spells for you, and Wisdom is your spellcasting ability for them. Whenever you gain a Ranger level, you can replace one of these cantrips with another Druid cantrip.

This is just a small QoL change. This basically just makes Druidic Warrior a real Fighting Style, but only available for Rangers. Without it, a Ranger wanting two Fighting Styles (such as Two-Weapon Fighting and Druidic Warrior) would only be able to do so if they took Druidic Warrior at this level and then used an ASI or multiclassed in order to get their second—they couldn't grab their other Fighting Style first and then grab this one later.

****Level 2: Tracker's Quarry**

You've improved your attunement to *Hunter's Mark*, empowering your ability to mark your target. You gain the following benefits:

Trace Tracker. You can target a creature with your *Hunter's Mark* without needing sight of them. So long as you or a creature whose senses you are perceiving through can pick up some trace of that creature—whether it's a footprint in the dirt or the sounds of footsteps from an invisible creature—that creature becomes a viable target for *Hunter's Mark*.

Quick Mark. When you or a creature you are commanding hits a target with an attack roll, you can either cast or transfer *Hunter's Mark* to the target. You immediately gain the benefits of *Hunter's Mark* on the new target; this allows you to deal your additional damage on the attack, along with any other benefits of *Hunter's Mark*, even though the target was not marked when you initially attacked them.

Roving Mark. You can transfer *Hunter's Mark* to a new target, either using Quick Mark or using a Bonus Action, even if the previous target has not reached 0 Hit Points yet.

Note: This feature is entirely new and doesn't replace any pre-existing features. While this feature doesn't do much to increase the damage of the class, it helps address some pain points of Hunter's Mark and improve its usability. Trace Tracker allows the utility portion of Hunter's Mark to actually be usable—gaining improvements to tracking a creature you can already see is entirely pointless, so I fixed that (and gave it usability with spells like Find Familiar or Beast Sense for further utility). Meanwhile, Quick Mark and Roving Mark provide relief from some of the often-painful aspects of the spell: being unable to transfer your mark over when you want to without needing to burn another precious spell slot, and requiring a Bonus Action to use the spell. Rangers are notoriously Bonus Action-heavy; commanding your companion creatures, making a dual-wielding attack, many useful spells for Ranger—they're all Bonus Actions. Removing that requirement here lets players be able

to do the things they want to do and still allows them to benefit from Hunter's Mark like WotC wants them to do.

Level 3: Ranger Subclass

You gain a Ranger subclass of your choice. A subclass is a specialization that grants you features at certain Ranger levels. For the rest of your career, you gain each of your subclass's features that are of your Ranger level or lower.

Level 4: Ability Score Improvement

You gain the Ability Score Improvement feat or another feat of your choice for which you qualify. You gain this feature again at Ranger levels 8, 12, and 16.

Level 5: Extra Attack

You can attack twice instead of once whenever you take the [Attack](#) action on your turn.

*Level 6: Roving

Your Speed increases by 10 feet while you aren't wearing Heavy armor. You also have a Climb Speed and a Swim Speed equal to your Speed.

Your experience with travel has also improved your ability to concentrate when distractions abound. Whenever you cast *Hunter's Mark*, you can decrease the duration of the spell to a maximum of one minute; when you cast it in this way, you do not have to Concentrate on it, and you can end it early with no action required.

Note: This change helps handle the ever-increasing burden of trying to use Hunter's Mark—which WotC really wants Rangers to do—while allowing players to actually use new (and often better) spells. Many of them require Concentration, so removing Concentration for Hunter's Mark specifically for combat makes it more usable. This also still allows it to be used as a Concentration spell for the tracking benefits or for benefiting from the spell over multiple combats, giving players more choice in how they use this spell.

**Level 6: Nature's Fury

Your attunement to nature has allowed you to channel the power of nature more effectively. Whenever you deal one of the following types of damage, you can attach an additional effect to the damage. Any creature who takes that damage type must succeed on a Constitution saving throw against your spell save DC or be subjected to the effect listed for that damage type; if an attack or spell effect causes you to deal multiple of these damage types, you may only pick one of these effects to attach to it. A creature afflicted by one of these effects can repeat the saving throw again at the end of each of their turns to try to end the effect early.

Acid: The target is Blinded for one minute.

Cold: The target is slowed, as per the *Slow* spell, for one minute. “An affected target’s Speed is halved, it takes a –2 penalty to AC and Dexterity saving throws, and it can’t take Reactions. On its turns, it can take either an action or a Bonus Action, not both, and it can make only one attack if it takes the Attack action. If it casts a spell with a Somatic component, there is a 25 percent chance the spell fails as a result of the target making the spell’s gestures too slowly.”

Fire: The target is branded by fire for one minute. While branded, the creature takes 1d6 Fire damage from the brand whenever an attack or spell deals damage to it.

Lightning: The target is Paralyzed until the start of your next turn.

Poison: The target is Poisoned for one minute. Each time the target fails the saving throw against this condition, they gain Disadvantage on the next saving throw they make while still Poisoned.

Thunder: The target is Deafened and Stunned for one minute. *(Note on a common mistake I see many players and DMs make: the Stunned condition doesn’t actually reduce a creature’s speed to 0, nor does the Incapacitated condition that Stunned gives. Therefore, a creature subjected to Thunder’s effect can still move.)*

You can apply one of these effects a number of times equal to your Wisdom modifier (minimum of once), regaining all uses on a long rest. You can also regain a use by expending a spell slot of at least 2nd level (no action required). Once per turn, landing a critical hit on a target with an attack that deals damage of one of these types also allows you to trigger that effect without consuming a use of this feature.

Note: The main purpose of this feature is mostly to give Rangers a cool, nature-themed combat feature that provides more utility and versatility in combat. When combined with other class features and the base Hunter’s Mark changes, this feature provides an interesting way for Rangers to debuff their targets and provide even more depth to even simple choices like “what damage type should I be using?”. The strong debuff possibilities provided here are meant to be strong enough to swing fights, giving Rangers options that can potentially help burn down Legendary Resistances from tough enemies to pave the way for stronger spellcasters to hit them with their own spells, while successfully landing one of these effects will make other martial characters very happy to pounce on. I have tried to make each option equally enticing, though balance is hard with something this complex; I could always come back and adjust this if need be.

Level 9: Expertise

Choose two of your skill proficiencies with which you lack Expertise. You gain [Expertise](#) in those skills.

*Level 9: Tireless

Primal forces now help fuel you on your journeys, granting you the following benefits.

Temporary Hit Points. As a [Magic](#) action, you can give yourself a number of [Temporary Hit Points](#) equal to 1d8 plus your Wisdom modifier (minimum of 1). You can use this action a number of times equal to your Wisdom modifier (minimum of once), and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

Decrease Exhaustion. Whenever you finish a Short Rest, your [Exhaustion](#) level, if any, decreases by 1.

Note: The only change to this feature is that it has been moved from level 10 to level 9. This was done to create space at level 10 for a feature that helps improve damage, putting it more in line with when other classes generally see a power boost.

**Level 10: Hunter's Precision

Whenever either you or a creature you command rolls an attack roll, the range of numbers you land a critical hit on increases by your Wisdom modifier (minimum 1). For instance, with a Wisdom modifier of +2, you roll a critical hit on an 18, 19, or 20 (two numbers lower than the standard critical hit of just 20).

Note: This feature is intended to help improve the damage of Rangers as they level; more frequent critical hits improves overall damage without directly impacting their individual attacks. This also helps improve the lack of scaling for Hunter's Mark; being able to crit more often means the additional damage of Hunter's Mark doubles as well. This also helps encourage Rangers at higher levels, who have likely already maxed out their Dexterity or Strength, to want to improve their Wisdom, as that has a direct impact on their critical hit frequency. From a thematic standpoint, improving crit rate for Rangers helps lean into the idea of being a precise hunter of monsters without directly affecting a character's ability to hit each particular target, making it slightly easier for DMs to balance around a Ranger in the party.

**Level 13: Relentless Striker

Once per turn, when you hit a target with an attack roll, you can change the hit into a critical hit. After resolving the effects of this hit, you gain one stack of Exhaustion.

Note: The old feature at this level prevented damage from breaking your Concentration on Hunter's Mark. This was bad, and so I killed it. There are other features that deal with the concentration of that spell now. Instead, the new feature helps lean into the Ranger's new focus on playing off critical hits, giving them a way to guarantee crits. This also plays into their Tireless feature, giving them a way to weaponize Exhaustion that they can then rest off on a Short Rest.

Level 14: Nature's Veil

You invoke spirits of nature to magically hide yourself. As a Bonus Action, you can give yourself the **Invisible** condition until the end of your next turn.

You can use this feature a number of times equal to your Wisdom modifier (minimum of once), and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

**Level 17: Executioner's Mark

You gain the following improvements to Hunter's Mark: you have Advantage on attack rolls against a creature already marked by your Hunter's Mark before making your attack. Additionally, the damage die of your Hunter's Mark is a d10 rather than a d6. Lastly, whenever you roll Initiative, you regain one use of Favored Enemy if you have any uses already expended.

Note: This feature combines 2024's 20th-level feature with its 17th-level feature, and then provides a slight bit extra. By 17th level, Advantage on attack rolls is very easy to come by—the Advantage granted by this feature is helpful but rarely necessary. Combining it with the increased damage die size from the lackluster 20th-level feature provides a small damage bump to make this feature slightly more useful. The last addition is a common feature among most other classes, granting Rangers more consistent use of a core class feature. By this level, it is unlikely that players will actually make any use of this ability, but it's a nice change for longer adventuring days—something Rangers are supposed to thrive on.

*Level 18: Feral Senses

Your connection to the forces of nature have heightened your senses. You gain **Blindsight** with a range of 30 feet; **if you already have Blindsight, the range is increased by 30 feet. Additionally, you have advantage on Wisdom (Perception and Survival) checks.**

Note: Feral Senses was an interesting concept, albeit somewhat underwhelming for such a high-level feature. The two main changes here (mechanically) are to account for already having Blindsight—such as, say, from a Fighting Style you could already have gotten from Ranger—and to provide a buff to the existing feature. Advantage on Perception and Survival helps lean into the idea that your senses are so heightened that you can catch every little

detail around you when you actually make the effort to examine your surroundings; combined with potential Expertise, at high levels, this makes Rangers nearly unparalleled at observing the world around them.

Level 19: Epic Boon

You gain an Epic Boon feat or another feat of your choice for which you qualify.

**Level 20: Foe Slayer

Your skill at taking down your marked targets is unsurpassable. Whenever you cast *Hunter's Mark*, you do not need to Concentrate on the spell; it lasts for the full duration, unless you end it early (no action required). Landing a critical hit (including through the use of Relentless Striker) on a target marked by the spell renders your foe weakened; they gain Vulnerability to the damage type done by your *Hunter's Mark* until the start of your next turn, regardless of if they are normally resistant or immune to it. This Vulnerability is applied before dealing the damage of your critical hit.

Additionally, your Wisdom score increases by 2, to a maximum of 23.

Note: The old version of Foe Slayer was incorporated into a lower-level feature. This new capstone provides some buffs to Hunter's Mark, making it even easier to use the spell and providing some interesting synergy and teamplay possibilities; it also increases the effective damage caused by the spell. The latter portion of the feature provides a benefit for those who do not want to use Hunter's Mark; it helps improve both spellcasting and critical hit chance, which feeds back into the first half of the feature by making it occur more frequently. This should (hopefully) be a strong enough feature to incentivize players to stick to Ranger for the last few levels, and it also (hopefully) feels very much like a Ranger capstone, not just a repurposed capstone from another class.

Spell Adjustments

The following two spells have seen some adjustments: *Hunter's Mark* and *Find Familiar*.

Find Familiar

The *Find Familiar* spell is added to the Ranger spell list.

Note: Having an animal companion is a common Ranger character fantasy, but if your vision for a Ranger doesn't involve your companion actually fighting alongside you, the only way to get one was to multiclass or spend one of your few feats to try to get one. Adding the spell to the Ranger list allows all Rangers to have access to an animal companion if they choose without forcing anyone to take the spell if they won't use one.

Hunter's Mark

Hunter's Mark has its damage type changed; instead of just Force damage, the user can choose from the following damage types whenever they deal their Hunter's Mark damage:

Acid, Cold, Fire, Force, Lightning, Poison, Thunder, or the same damage type as whatever weapon or unarmed strike they made the attack with.

Note: Making Hunter's Mark have a flexible damage type allows Rangers additional versatility on the battlefield (and also enables some interesting synergies). With just this change alone, a Ranger can scout for various damage resistances, vulnerabilities, or other interactions (like damage types shutting down certain creatures' regenerative capabilities) without having to commit all their damage to a single type. Being able to use 1d6 poison damage to determine if a monster is immune to poison before your caster spends their whole Action casting a poison-based spell is very helpful, for instance; this may be a small change, but it can make a surprising amount of difference in some combats. (Also, the reasoning for the damage types chosen is that most of these are damage types that are common in nature.)